

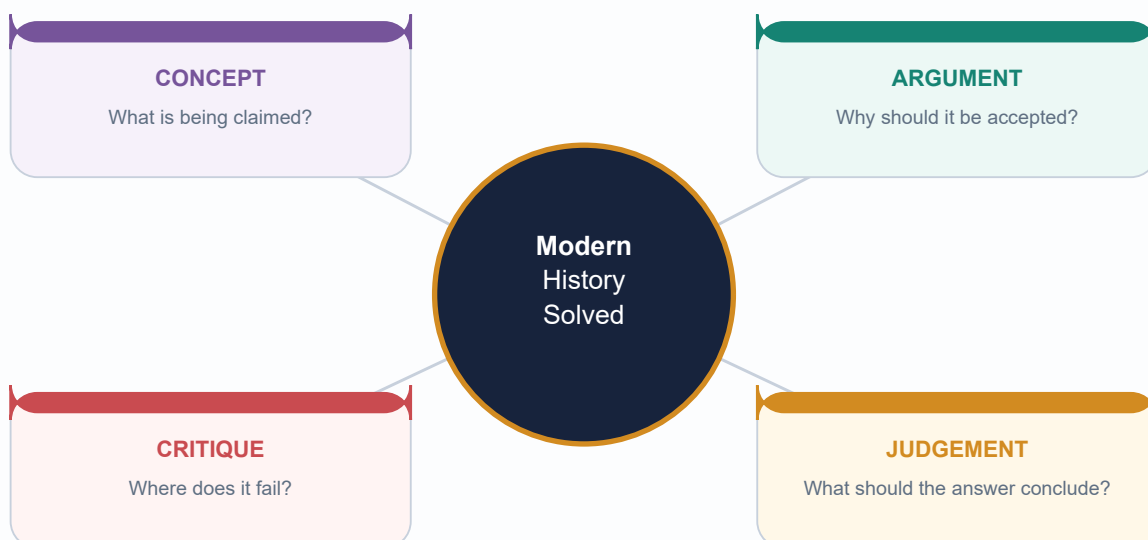
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Modern History 03 - Solved Practice Workbook

The Beginnings of European Settlements

5 routed/adjacent PYQs | 48 hard MCQs | 12 remedials | 9 solved Mains

Strict A -> B -> C -> D option rotation



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Workbook scope and counts

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- This solved workbook contains all five relevant routed/adjacent PYQs, 48 hard MCQs, 12 remedial MCQs and 3 each solved 10/15/20-mark Mains questions.
- Correct options rotate A -> B -> C -> D through all 60 MCQs.
- Visual practice uses the original route map, settlement-fort schematic and non-inevitable process diagram.

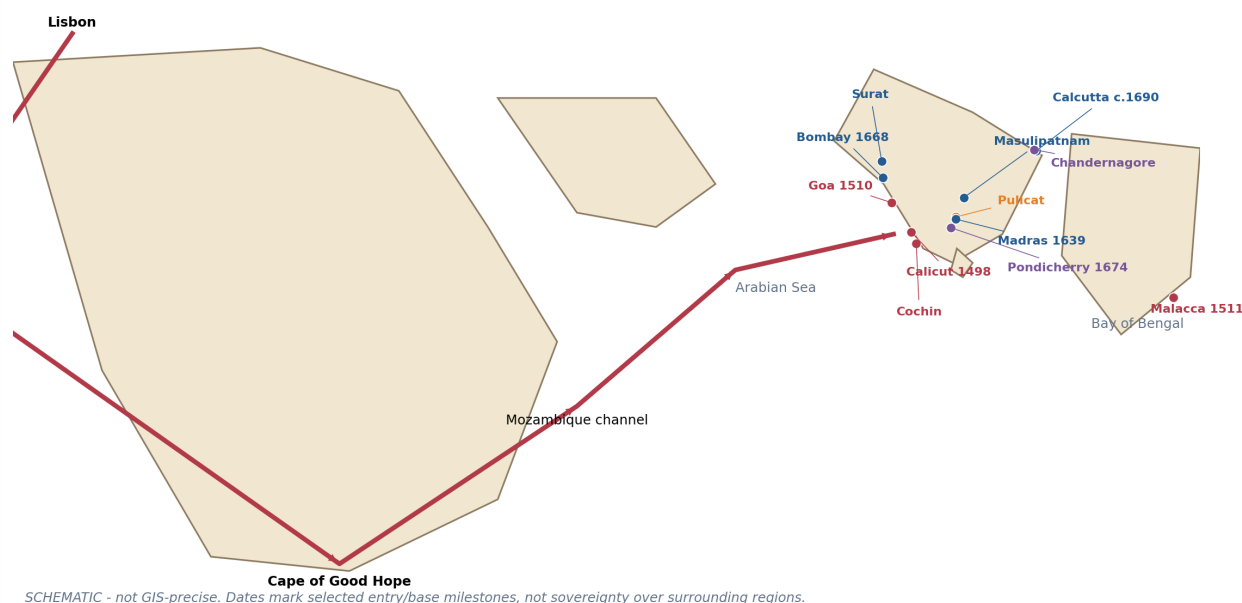
HIGH

Visual practice 01 - Route and settlement map

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

ORIGINAL GENERATED VISUAL ASSET

Cape Route and the Coastal Settlement Chain



Use the schematic for location-sequence questions; never infer territorial boundaries from the route line.

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic where stated and not external copyrighted imagery.

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Map task A: trace Lisbon -> Cape -> Mozambique channel -> Calicut, then identify Goa, Surat/Bombay, Coromandel nodes and Bengal nodes.
- Map task B: classify each labelled point as first contact, Portuguese base, Dutch base, English base or French base.
- Model inference: the map shows a coastal network, not continuous territorial occupation. Every node requires a hinterland, political permission and maritime linkage.

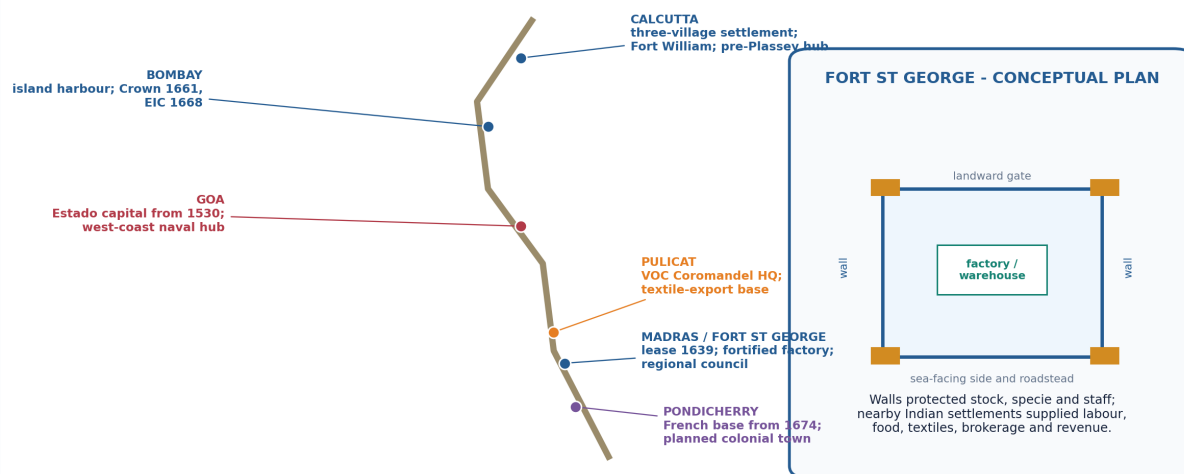
HIGH

Visual practice 02 - Site and fort reading

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

ORIGINAL GENERATED VISUAL ASSET

Settlement-Fort Network and a Compact Fortified-Factory Schematic



SCHEMATIC - nodes and fort plan are relational, not measured archaeological plans.

The site network tests port-company matching and the economic dependence of fortified enclaves.

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic where stated and not external copyrighted imagery.

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why did a fortified factory remain dependent on a surrounding Indian town?
- Model answer: the walls protected stock, specie and personnel, but food, labour, textiles, brokerage, transport, customs and credit came through surrounding Indian communities and authorities.
- Question: Identify the transfer chain unique to Bombay. Model answer: Portuguese possession -> English Crown in 1661 -> EIC in 1668.

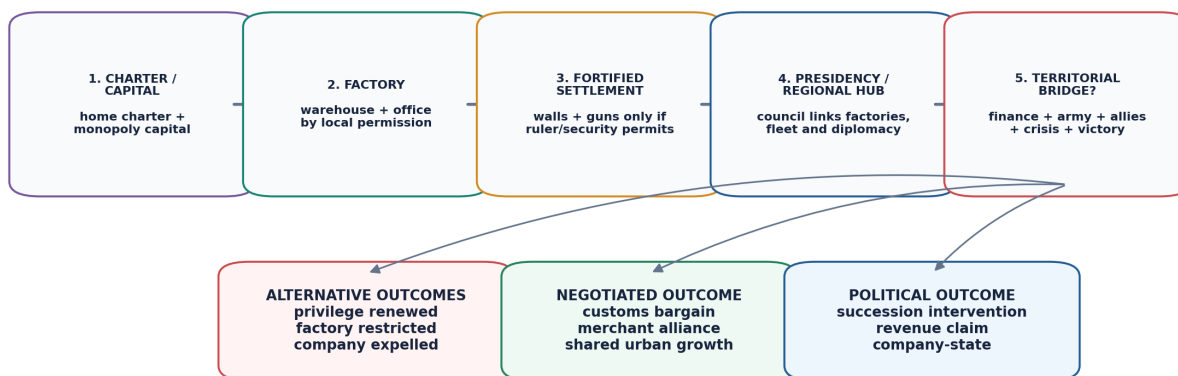
HIGH

Visual practice 03 - Non-inevitable process

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

ORIGINAL GENERATED VISUAL ASSET

From Factory to Territory? A Conditional, Non-Inevitable Process



A charter did not create sovereignty; each transition depended on Indian permission, military balance, finance, alliances, geography and contingency.

The diagram is an answer framework: every transition requires a named condition and a counter-example.

Original deterministic study visual generated for this package; schematic where stated and not external copyrighted imagery.

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Insert one named success and one failure at every arrow from factory to territorial bridge.

- Model route: Surat 1613 proves permission; Fort St George proves fortification; Bombay/Madras councils prove regional coordination; Child's War proves possible defeat; Carnatic claimant politics and later Bengal revenue prove additional political-fiscal conditions.

HIGH

PYQ 01 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q33: first-quarter EIC factories

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: In the first quarter of the seventeenth century, in which of the following was/were the factory/factories of the English East India Company located? 1. Broach 2. Chicacole 3. Trichinopoly. Options: (A) 1 only (B) 1 and 2 (C) 3 only (D) 2 and 3.
- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: A, 1 only. Confidence: high.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Broach belonged to the early western factory network alongside Surat, Ahmedabad and Agra. Chicacole and Trichinopoly were not EIC factories in the specified first-quarter window. The elimination depends on time and institutional geography, not merely knowing later British centres.
- Why this earns marks: it tests the date window, identifies Broach within the Surat-centred network and avoids projecting later south-Indian expansion backward.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - UPSC Prelims 2021 Q39: St Francis XavierPrelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History**CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT**

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. St Francis Xavier was one of the founding members of the Jesuit Order. 2. He died in Goa and a church is dedicated to him there. 3. His feast is celebrated in Goa each year. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: C, 1 and 3 only. Confidence: high.

- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is correct: Xavier was among the founding companions of the Society of Jesus. Statement 2 is false because he died in 1552 on Shangchuan Island off China, although his remains are preserved in Goa. Statement 3 is correct; the feast is celebrated annually in Goa.

- Why this earns marks: it separates place of death from place of burial and uses the exact institutional fact about the Jesuit Order.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

HIGH

PYQ 03 - UPSC Prelims 2022 Q59: Dutch, Portuguese and English settlements

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Consider the statements: 1. The Dutch established factories/warehouses on the east coast on lands granted by Gajapati rulers. 2. Albuquerque captured Goa from the Bijapur Sultanate. 3. The EIC established a factory at Madras on land leased from a representative of the Vijayanagara empire. Options: (A) 1 and 2 only (B) 2 and 3 only (C) 1 and 3 only (D) 1, 2 and 3.

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY: B, 2 and 3 only. Confidence: high.

- Solved explanation / model answer: Statement 1 is incorrect: Pulicat and other Dutch east-coast bases are not safely attributed to grants by Gajapati rulers. Statement 2 is correct: Albuquerque captured Goa from Bijapur in 1510. Statement 3 is correct: the Madras lease came through a local Nayak authority linked to the Chandragiri/Vijayanagara political order.

- Why this earns marks: it verifies each ruler-company-place relationship and states the political chain behind the Madras lease without treating it as modern territorial cession.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

HIGH

PYQ 04 - UPSC Prelims 2025 Q75: Portuguese crop transfers

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: How many of papaya, pineapple and guava were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries? Options: (A) Only one (B) Only two (C) All three (D) None.
- OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: C, all three. UPSC Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination 2025, GS-I, Series A official key.
- Solved explanation / model answer: Papaya, pineapple and guava were all introduced through Portuguese maritime networks. The safe formulation is the official question's broad sixteenth-seventeenth-century window; do not assign an unsupported single year to each crop.
- Why this earns marks: it uses the locally held official key and adds the chronology caution needed to prevent overclaiming.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

HIGH

PYQ 05 - Adjacent bridge: UPSC GS-I Mains 2022 Q2Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History**CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT**

- Question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising of Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (150 words, 10 marks)
- VERIFIED QUESTION TEXT FROM LOCAL OFFICIAL 2022 GS-I PAPER. Included as a bounded bridge; its full ownership lies in Modern Topic 05.
- Solved explanation / model answer: The Company converted a commercial network into a fiscal-military system. Presidency coordination joined Madras, Bombay and Bengal to oceanic reinforcement; standard drill, artillery organisation and regular cash payment sustained sepoy units. Named evidence includes Fort St George as an early garrison hub, Bengal revenue after the 1765 Diwani, and Indian bankers, suppliers and soldiers who enabled campaigning. By contrast, many rulers faced fragmented command, irregular payment, rival claimants and weak inter-state coordination. Yet defeat was not inevitable: Mysore checked the Company in the Second Anglo-Mysore War, Travancore defeated the Dutch at Colachel and the Marathas forced the Treaty of Salbai. The decisive advantage was therefore not European ethnicity or weapon ownership but the Company's integration of finance, logistics, naval mobility, command and Indian alliances over repeated wars.
- Why this earns marks: it answers 'why' through linked institutions, names fiscal and settlement evidence, keeps Indian agency central and qualifies consistency with major reverses.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

PYQ provenance: local official paper/routing ledger; inferred keys are never presented as official.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History**CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT**

- Question: Which statement best distinguishes maritime exploration from territorial empire?
- A. Opening a route establishes contact; empire requires enforceable jurisdiction, revenue and force.
- B. Any ocean voyage automatically creates sovereignty.
- C. A factory is already a territorial province.
- D. A royal charter transfers Indian land to the company.
- Answer: A. Opening a route establishes contact; empire requires enforceable jurisdiction, revenue and force.
- Explanation: The Cape voyage opened direct contact, while sovereignty required later Indian political and fiscal conditions.
- Evidence anchor: Conceptual stages.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 02

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The Portuguese Estado da India was best described as:
- A. A privately owned Portuguese joint-stock company identical to the VOC.
- B. A dispersed Crown administrative-military network of forts, fleets and royal factories.
- C. A modern nation-state with continuous Asian borders.
- D. A Mughal naval department headquartered at Goa.
- Answer: B. A dispersed Crown administrative-military network of forts, fleets and royal factories.
- Explanation: The Estado was a Crown formation under a viceroy or governor; distance and local negotiation limited central control.
- Evidence anchor: Estado da India.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 03

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: What was the primary function of the cartaz?
- A. To grant the EIC duty-free Bengal trade.
- B. To charter the French Compagnie des Indes.
- C. To license and regulate shipping under Portuguese maritime coercion.
- D. To appoint a VOC governor at Pulicat.
- Answer: C. To license and regulate shipping under Portuguese maritime coercion.
- Explanation: Cartaz was a Portuguese naval pass, not a farman, charter or company appointment.
- Evidence anchor: Cartaz.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which chronology is correct?
- A. Goa capital 1498 -> Calicut 1510 -> Cochin 1530.
- B. Goa capture 1505 -> Calicut 1510 -> capital 1661.
- C. Calicut 1510 -> Goa capital 1511 -> Goa capture 1530.
- D. Calicut 1498 -> Goa capture 1510 -> Goa capital 1530.
- Answer: D. Calicut 1498 -> Goa capture 1510 -> Goa capital 1530.
- Explanation: Capture, administrative creation and capital transfer are separate milestones.
- Evidence anchor: Portuguese chronology.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 05**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why is calling the Estado da India a modern nation-state misleading?
- A. Its authority was nodal and Crown-centred, spread across forts and sea lanes rather than continuous territory.
- B. It had no connection to the Portuguese Crown.
- C. It consisted only of missionaries and no trade.
- D. It exercised uniform inland administration across India.
- Answer: A. Its authority was nodal and Crown-centred, spread across forts and sea lanes rather than continuous territory.
- Explanation: The network exercised public power but lacked modern bounded territorial continuity.
- Evidence anchor: Political form.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 06**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which Xavier statement is accurate?
- A. He founded the EIC and died at Surat.
- B. He was a founding Jesuit, died off China and his remains are in Goa.
- C. He died in Goa and was buried at Pulicat.
- D. He was a Dutch missionary at Nagapattinam.
- Answer: B. He was a founding Jesuit, died off China and his remains are in Goa.
- Explanation: The place-of-death versus place-of-remains distinction is the central UPSC trap.
- Evidence anchor: Mission history.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 07**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which combination is safely linked to Portuguese maritime networks?
- A. Fort William and the Permanent Settlement.
- B. Pulicat and VOC spice monopoly.
- C. Goa printing press and the introduction of papaya, pineapple and guava.
- D. Pondicherry grid and Dupleix's governorship.
- Answer: C. Goa printing press and the introduction of papaya, pineapple and guava.
- Explanation: Goa press dates to 1556; the 2025 official key confirms all three fruits.
- Evidence anchor: Cultural transfer.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 08**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which is the strongest explanation of Portuguese decline?
- A. Religious policy alone caused every loss.
- B. The Portuguese voluntarily ended Asian trade in 1600.
- C. Indian rulers never resisted, so only climate mattered.
- D. Overextension, limited resources, company competition, European war and Asian resistance acted together.
- Answer: D. Overextension, limited resources, company competition, European war and Asian resistance acted together.
- Explanation: A multi-causal hierarchy avoids monocausal and stereotyped answers.
- Evidence anchor: Portuguese decline.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 09**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The VOC's 1602 charter is significant because it:
- A. Created a joint-stock corporation with extensive commercial and quasi-sovereign powers.
- B. Transferred Goa from Bijapur.
- C. Issued the Mughal cartaz.
- D. Made Pondicherry a French presidency.
- Answer: A. Created a joint-stock corporation with extensive commercial and quasi-sovereign powers.
- Explanation: The VOC could wage war and make treaties, but enforcement still depended on local circumstances.
- Evidence anchor: VOC structure.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 10**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which pairing is correct?
- A. Pondicherry - Portuguese capital.
- B. Pulicat - principal Dutch Coromandel base.
- C. Fort St George - French factory.
- D. Goa - English presidency from 1613.
- Answer: B. Pulicat - principal Dutch Coromandel base.
- Explanation: Pulicat is the high-frequency Dutch east-coast location.
- Evidence anchor: Dutch bases.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 11**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why were Indian textiles central to Dutch strategy?
- A. The VOC avoided all Asian trade beyond India.
- B. Textiles were used only to pay Mughal land revenue.
- C. They served as commodities and purchasing power in intra-Asian spice trade.
- D. Dutch law prohibited bullion or barter.
- Answer: C. They served as commodities and purchasing power in intra-Asian spice trade.
- Explanation: India was commercially central even when territorial priority lay in Indonesia.
- Evidence anchor: VOC business model.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 12**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: What does Colachel 1741 demonstrate?
- A. The Portuguese captured Madras from the French.
- B. The EIC received the 1717 farman.
- C. The Dutch conquered Bengal territorially.
- D. An Indian regional state, Travancore, could defeat a European company force.
- Answer: D. An Indian regional state, Travancore, could defeat a European company force.
- Explanation: The battle is strong anti-teleological evidence; Dutch trade nevertheless continued.
- Evidence anchor: Indian resistance.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 13**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The EIC charter of 1600 primarily:
- A. Created a corporate monopoly under English law.
- B. Granted zamindari over Calcutta.
- C. Gave Surat to England.
- D. Transferred Bombay from Portugal to the Company.
- Answer: A. Created a corporate monopoly under English law.
- Explanation: Home charter and Indian political permission are distinct legal stages.
- Evidence anchor: EIC charter.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 14**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The naval encounter at Swally in 1612 mattered because it:
- A. Made the EIC emperor of Gujarat.
- B. Improved English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence.
- C. Ended all Portuguese trade in Asia.
- D. Created the French company.
- Answer: B. Improved English bargaining credibility at the Mughal court against Portuguese influence.
- Explanation: Swally changed Mughal calculations but did not transfer sovereignty.
- Evidence anchor: Swally.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 15**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Sir Thomas Roe's embassy is best understood as:
- A. A conquest of Agra by EIC troops.
- B. A Portuguese mission to Bijapur.
- C. Diplomacy that secured or clarified commercial privileges under Mughal authority.
- D. A Dutch purchase of Bombay.
- Answer: C. Diplomacy that secured or clarified commercial privileges under Mughal authority.
- Explanation: Roe's farman did not create territorial rule.
- Evidence anchor: Mughal diplomacy.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 16**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which place belonged to the EIC factory network in the first quarter of the seventeenth century?
- A. Trichinopoly.
- B. Chicacole.
- C. Pondicherry.
- D. Broach.
- Answer: D. Broach.
- Explanation: This mirrors the 2021 UPSC demand; Broach formed part of the Surat-centred network.
- Evidence anchor: Factory geography.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 17**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which sequence best describes the English Coromandel chain?
- A. Masulipatnam factory -> Madras lease -> Fort St George.
- B. Bombay lease -> Goa capture -> Pulicat.
- C. Surat charter -> Chandernagore -> Diu.
- D. Pondicherry -> Calcutta -> Cochin.
- Answer: A. Masulipatnam factory -> Madras lease -> Fort St George.
- Explanation: Masulipatnam preceded the 1639 Madras lease and fortification from 1640.
- Evidence anchor: Coromandel.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 18**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Fort St George initially protected:
- A. The Portuguese viceroy at Goa.
- B. Company warehouses, specie, staff and a growing council at Madras.
- C. The VOC spice islands.
- D. The French governor at Chandernagore.
- Answer: B. Company warehouses, specie, staff and a growing council at Madras.
- Explanation: A fortified factory was a defensive-commercial hub, not automatic hinterland rule.
- Evidence anchor: Fortification.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 19**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which Bombay chronology is correct?
- A. EIC conquest in 1600 -> Mughal farman in 1613.
- B. French purchase in 1664 -> Dutch transfer in 1668.
- C. Portuguese possession -> English Crown in 1661 -> EIC in 1668.
- D. Job Charnock founded Bombay in 1690.
- Answer: C. Portuguese possession -> English Crown in 1661 -> EIC in 1668.
- Explanation: The Crown-company transfer sequence is a standard factual trap.
- Evidence anchor: Bombay.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 20**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The safest statement on Calcutta's origins is:
- A. Job Charnock created an empty city and undisputedly founded it.
- B. The 1717 farman first created all three villages.
- C. Calcutta became sovereign EIC territory before Child's War.
- D. c.1690 is a conventional Company milestone within cumulative settlement of three villages.
- Answer: D. c.1690 is a conventional Company milestone within cumulative settlement of three villages.
- Explanation: The founder label compresses existing settlements and later acquisitions.
- Evidence anchor: Calcutta.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 21**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman:
- A. Expanded valuable commercial privileges but did not grant Diwani or sovereignty.
- B. Chartered the EIC in London.
- C. Transferred Bombay from the Crown.
- D. Founded the VOC.
- Answer: A. Expanded valuable commercial privileges but did not grant Diwani or sovereignty.
- Explanation: Privilege, revenue right and corporate charter must be separated.
- Evidence anchor: 1717 farman.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 22**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: What did Child's War reveal?
- A. The EIC was territorially supreme by 1686.
- B. The Mughal state could defeat and discipline the EIC, which returned as a petitioner.
- C. The Dutch captured Goa.
- D. The French defeated Travancore.
- Answer: B. The Mughal state could defeat and discipline the EIC, which returned as a petitioner.
- Explanation: This is central evidence against inevitable conquest.
- Evidence anchor: Child's War.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 23**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: In seventeenth-century company usage, a factory was:
- A. A mechanised textile mill.
- B. A territorial province ruled by a governor-general.
- C. A trading depot with warehouses, offices and residences.
- D. A naval pass for merchant ships.
- Answer: C. A trading depot with warehouses, offices and residences.
- Explanation: Factor meant commercial agent; manufacture was not the defining function.
- Evidence anchor: Terminology.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 24**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: A presidency was principally:
- A. A Portuguese maritime pass.
- B. A Jesuit religious order.
- C. A Mughal revenue-free village.
- D. A regional council system coordinating factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence.
- Answer: D. A regional council system coordinating factories, shipping, diplomacy and defence.
- Explanation: Presidency status increased coordination without automatically creating territorial sovereignty.
- Evidence anchor: Administration.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 25**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The French Compagnie des Indes was founded in:
- A. 1664 under Colbert's state sponsorship.
- B. 1498 by Vasco da Gama.
- C. 1602 by the Dutch States-General.
- D. 1717 by Farrukhsiyar.
- Answer: A. 1664 under Colbert's state sponsorship.
- Explanation: French entry came after Portuguese, Dutch and English institutional foundations.
- Evidence anchor: French company.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 26**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which French sequence is correct?
- A. Goa -> Diu -> Cochin.
- B. Surat/Masulipatnam -> Pondicherry -> Chandernagore.
- C. Pulicat -> Nagapattinam -> Chinsura.
- D. Surat -> Madras -> Bombay.
- Answer: B. Surat/Masulipatnam -> Pondicherry -> Chandernagore.
- Explanation: The sequence separates French from Portuguese, Dutch and English networks.
- Evidence anchor: French bases.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 27**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Dupleix is relevant to this topic mainly as:
- A. The founder of the VOC.
- B. The conqueror of Goa in 1510.
- C. A bridge from commercial settlements to intervention in Indian succession politics.
- D. The issuer of the 1717 farman.
- Answer: C. A bridge from commercial settlements to intervention in Indian succession politics.
- Explanation: Detailed Carnatic war chronology is bounded, but the mechanism matters.
- Evidence anchor: Dupleix.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 28**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which factor most safely explains French limits against the English?
- A. An inherent French dislike of commerce.
- B. Absence of any French settlement in India.
- C. A Portuguese victory at Wandiwash.
- D. Discontinuous naval-financial support, state interference, European priorities and Indian alliances.
- Answer: D. Discontinuous naval-financial support, state interference, European priorities and Indian alliances.
- Explanation: Multi-causal comparison replaces national stereotypes and generalship-only explanations.
- Evidence anchor: French limits.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 29**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which comparison is accurate?
- A. Portuguese Crown Estado; Dutch VOC; English EIC; French state-sponsored Compagnie.
- B. All four were identical private firms.
- C. Only the Portuguese had any public power.
- D. All four began as Indian farmans.
- Answer: A. Portuguese Crown Estado; Dutch VOC; English EIC; French state-sponsored Compagnie.
- Explanation: Institutional form shaped finance and strategy but did not mechanically determine outcome.
- Evidence anchor: Company comparison.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 30**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why is the factory-to-empire sequence non-inevitable?
- A. Every charter contained automatic Indian tax rights.
- B. Each transition required permission, finance, fortification, alliances, crisis and enforceable victory.
- C. European weapons guaranteed victory in every battle.
- D. Indian merchants had no role in settlements.
- Answer: B. Each transition required permission, finance, fortification, alliances, crisis and enforceable victory.
- Explanation: Failed wars, restrictions and continuing enclaves demonstrate alternative outcomes.
- Evidence anchor: Anti-teleology.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 31**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which example most directly shows ruler agency?
- A. The EIC chartered itself without a Crown.
- B. Bullion flowed because no Indian goods were available.
- C. Aurangzeb's government defeated the EIC in Child's War and restored trade on submission.
- D. Factories manufactured steam engines.
- Answer: C. Aurangzeb's government defeated the EIC in Child's War and restored trade on submission.
- Explanation: Rulers could grant, restrict, expel and restore companies.
- Evidence anchor: Indian rulers.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 32**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Dubashes and brokers were important because they:
- A. Commanded the Portuguese Crown in Lisbon.
- B. Issued Mughal farmans independently.
- C. Replaced all Indian merchants.
- D. Connected language, procurement, credit, customs and political access.
- Answer: D. Connected language, procurement, credit, customs and political access.
- Explanation: Intermediation was a source of agency and conflict within port societies.
- Evidence anchor: Brokers.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 33**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why did bullion generally flow into India through company trade?
- A. Indian exports often exceeded demand for European goods, requiring specie settlement.
- B. India imported no commodities whatsoever.
- C. The cartaz required all ships to carry gold.
- D. Bullion was a Mughal tax on the VOC charter.
- Answer: A. Indian exports often exceeded demand for European goods, requiring specie settlement.
- Explanation: Favourable trade balances and Asian purchasing patterns explain the direction.
- Evidence anchor: Bullion.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 34**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which regional commodity pairing is safest?
- A. Malabar - only silver mines.
- B. Bengal - cottons, silk and access to Bihar saltpetre.
- C. Coromandel - no textiles.
- D. Surat - exclusively tea.
- Answer: B. Bengal - cottons, silk and access to Bihar saltpetre.
- Explanation: The pairing links port to hinterland without claiming exclusivity.
- Evidence anchor: Commodities.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 35**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Saltpetre is especially associated with:
- A. Pondicherry vineyards.
- B. Goa's Jesuit colleges alone.
- C. Bihar-Patna supply networks feeding Bengal and company trade.
- D. Bombay cotton mills in 1600.
- Answer: C. Bihar-Patna supply networks feeding Bengal and company trade.
- Explanation: Saltpetre was a strategic export used in gunpowder production.
- Evidence anchor: Saltpetre.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 36**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which statement on shipbuilding is most accurate?
- A. Europeans introduced all shipbuilding knowledge to India.
- B. Indian ships were prohibited from oceanic trade before 1498.
- C. The VOC never purchased Asian vessels.
- D. Indian yards built ships used by Indian merchants and European companies.
- Answer: D. Indian yards built ships used by Indian merchants and European companies.
- Explanation: Asian navigation and Indian productive skill coexisted with European artillery advantages.
- Evidence anchor: Shipbuilding.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 37**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: European port settlements should be understood as:
- A. Layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves.
- B. Self-sufficient European islands with no hinterland links.
- C. Pure military camps without trade.
- D. Uniform cities built from one metropolitan plan.
- Answer: A. Layered urban spaces dependent on Indian labour, markets and authority despite fortified enclaves.
- Explanation: Walls separated jurisdiction more than economy.
- Evidence anchor: Urban change.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 38**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which is the safest cultural-causality statement?
- A. All cultural change resulted from one missionary.
- B. Maritime routes, mission institutions and local adaptation jointly shaped Portuguese cultural effects.
- C. Every crop arrived in a precisely known year.
- D. Architecture was copied without Indian labour or materials.
- Answer: B. Maritime routes, mission institutions and local adaptation jointly shaped Portuguese cultural effects.
- Explanation: Cultural exchange needs chronology, institution, local agency and coercion cautions.
- Evidence anchor: Cultural interaction.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 39**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which site-style pairing is accurate?
- A. Pulicat - Mughal capital.
- B. Bombay - Jesuit headquarters from 1498.
- C. Old Goa - Indo-Portuguese church ensemble; Pondicherry - French grid tradition.
- D. Calcutta - Portuguese Estado capital.
- Answer: C. Old Goa - Indo-Portuguese church ensemble; Pondicherry - French grid tradition.
- Explanation: The pairing uses material evidence without treating surviving fabric as unchanged.
- Evidence anchor: Heritage.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 40**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which event happened outside India but influenced English-Dutch strategy?
- A. Swally, 1612.
- B. Colachel, 1741.
- C. Hugli, 1632.
- D. Amboyna, 1623.
- Answer: D. Amboyna, 1623.
- Explanation: Amboyna intensified rivalry in the spice islands and encouraged English reorientation.
- Evidence anchor: Rivalry.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 41**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which cause should not stand alone in an explanation of Portuguese decline?
- A. Religious intolerance.
- B. Strategic overextension.
- C. Dutch-English competition.
- D. Asian resistance.
- Answer: A. Religious intolerance.
- Explanation: Religious coercion mattered, but decline also involved finance, war, shipping and regional politics.
- Evidence anchor: Causal hierarchy.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 42**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why did Dutch strength not become Indian territorial empire?
- A. The Dutch had no factories in India.
- B. The VOC prioritised Indonesian monopoly while using India commercially.
- C. Indian textiles had no value in Asian trade.
- D. The Dutch company lacked any charter.
- Answer: B. The VOC prioritised Indonesian monopoly while using India commercially.
- Explanation: Strategic portfolio choice explains commercial depth with territorial restraint.
- Evidence anchor: Dutch outcome.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 43**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Why did the French lag the English politically?
- A. France never formed an East India company.
- B. Pondicherry was a Portuguese base.
- C. Their Indian effort faced weaker naval-financial continuity and greater home-state strategic constraints.
- D. Dupleix refused all Indian alliances.
- Answer: C. Their Indian effort faced weaker naval-financial continuity and greater home-state strategic constraints.
- Explanation: The answer compares systems, not courage or nationality.
- Evidence anchor: French outcome.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 44**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which factor belongs to the later multiplier, not the original English foothold?
- A. The 1600 charter.
- B. Surat permission.
- C. The 1639 Madras lease.
- D. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani.
- Answer: D. Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani.
- Explanation: Later Bengal resources cannot explain seventeenth-century settlement formation.
- Evidence anchor: Timing.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 45**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The Danish presence is best used as:
- A. A bounded comparison through Tranquebar and later Serampore without displacing the four-power spine.
- B. The main territorial conqueror of Bengal.
- C. The issuer of the Portuguese cartaz.
- D. The founder of Fort St George.
- Answer: A. A bounded comparison through Tranquebar and later Serampore without displacing the four-power spine.
- Explanation: Danish settlements show continued commercial plurality but limited political weight.
- Evidence anchor: Danish comparison.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 46**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which source claim requires the most caution?
- A. A farman records an intended privilege.
- B. A company charter proves actual sovereignty over every claimed Asian territory.
- C. A fort can reveal spatial priorities.
- D. Factory records can document commodity orders.
- Answer: B. A company charter proves actual sovereignty over every claimed Asian territory.
- Explanation: Legal claims and implementation must be compared.
- Evidence anchor: Source criticism.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 47**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which chronological order is correct?
- A. VOC 1498 -> EIC 1510 -> Surat 1664 -> Madras 1717.
- B. Madras 1600 -> Surat 1602 -> Goa 1613 -> Calicut 1639.
- C. EIC charter 1600 -> VOC 1602 -> Surat factory 1613 -> Madras 1639.
- D. French company 1498 -> EIC 1505 -> VOC 1510 -> Bombay 1530.
- Answer: C. EIC charter 1600 -> VOC 1602 -> Surat factory 1613 -> Madras 1639.
- Explanation: The sequence is a core recall ladder.
- Evidence anchor: Chronology.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 48**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The company-state concept is most safely applied when:
- A. Every trader is assumed to be a state.
- B. A factory is equated with Diwani.
- C. Indian political authority is ignored.
- D. Corporate public powers are distinguished from later enforceable territorial sovereignty.
- Answer: D. Corporate public powers are distinguished from later enforceable territorial sovereignty.
- Explanation: The concept clarifies mixed public-private power but can overstate early territorial control.
- Evidence anchor: Historiography.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 49**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which statement is correct about a factory?
- A. It was a commercial depot and could exist without fortification.
- B. It always manufactured textiles.
- C. It was identical to a presidency.
- D. It automatically collected land revenue.
- Answer: A. It was a commercial depot and could exist without fortification.
- Explanation: This remedial item targets the most common terminology error.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial terminology.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 50**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which Xavier statement must be rejected?
- A. He was a founding Jesuit.
- B. He died in Goa.
- C. His remains are in Bom Jesus.
- D. His feast is celebrated in Goa.
- Answer: B. He died in Goa.
- Explanation: Xavier died off China in 1552.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial Xavier.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 51**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which association is false?
- A. Job Charnock - conventional Calcutta milestone.
- B. Charles II - Bombay Crown acquisition.
- C. Job Charnock - Bombay transfer.
- D. EIC - Bombay lease in 1668.
- Answer: C. Job Charnock - Bombay transfer.
- Explanation: Bombay and Calcutta origin stories must not be mixed.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial Bombay.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 52**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: What did the 1717 farman not do?
- A. Expand Bengal privileges.
- B. Create later customs disputes.
- C. Support Company claims around Calcutta.
- D. Charter the EIC in England.
- Answer: D. Charter the EIC in England.
- Explanation: The EIC charter dates to 1600.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial farman.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 53**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Wandiwash 1760 was:
- A. An Anglo-French battle in the later Carnatic transition.
- B. A Portuguese-Dutch battle for Goa.
- C. The event that created the VOC.
- D. The Mughal capture of Hugli.
- Answer: A. An Anglo-French battle in the later Carnatic transition.
- Explanation: It is a bounded later event, not the core settlement chronology.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial rivalry.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 54**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The Dutch in India were primarily:
- A. Absent after 1623.
- B. Commercial actors integrated into an Indonesia-first VOC strategy.
- C. Territorial rulers of most of India.
- D. A branch of the French company.
- Answer: B. Commercial actors integrated into an Indonesia-first VOC strategy.
- Explanation: India remained important for textiles and bulk trade.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial Dutch.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 55**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which formulation is accurate?
- A. It was a modern federal republic.
- B. It was the Dutch joint-stock company.
- C. The Estado da India was a Portuguese Crown network centred on nodal bases.
- D. It ruled continuous Indian territory.
- Answer: C. The Estado da India was a Portuguese Crown network centred on nodal bases.
- Explanation: Political form and spatial reach must be stated precisely.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial Estado.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 56**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Cartaz and farman differ because:
- A. Both were English charters.
- B. Both meant factory warehouses.
- C. Both were French urban grids.
- D. Cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass; farman was a sovereign Indian order.
- Answer: D. Cartaz was a Portuguese maritime pass; farman was a sovereign Indian order.
- Explanation: The distinction prevents cross-institution confusion.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial terms.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Which site pairing is correct?
- A. Pulicat - Dutch; Pondicherry - French.
- B. Pulicat - Portuguese; Pondicherry - English.
- C. Pulicat - French; Pondicherry - Dutch.
- D. Both were Mughal capitals.
- Answer: A. Pulicat - Dutch; Pondicherry - French.
- Explanation: Simple site-company precision underlies harder comparisons.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial sites.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 58**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: What was the broad direction of specie in early company trade?
- A. Bullion uniformly left India before any exports.
- B. Bullion generally entered India to pay for sought-after exports.
- C. No bullion moved in Asian trade.
- D. Only the cartaz determined specie flows.
- Answer: B. Bullion generally entered India to pay for sought-after exports.
- Explanation: Direction follows the trade balance, with regional and temporal variation.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial bullion.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 59**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: Fortification should be treated as:
- A. Proof of complete inland sovereignty.
- B. A synonym for charter.
- C. A contingent step requiring resources and political tolerance, not automatic empire.
- D. A purely religious institution.
- Answer: C. A contingent step requiring resources and political tolerance, not automatic empire.
- Explanation: Host rulers could ban, besiege or permit forts.
- Evidence anchor: Remedial fortification.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 60**

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Question: The safest Calcutta formulation is:
 - A. An empty city founded solely by Charnock.
 - B. A Portuguese capital captured in 1510.
 - C. A Dutch spice island.
 - D. A cumulative three-village settlement conventionally linked to Charnock's 1690 return.
 - Answer: D. A cumulative three-village settlement conventionally linked to Charnock's 1690 return.
 - Explanation: This avoids the founder myth while retaining the conventional date.
 - Evidence anchor: Remedial Calcutta.
-

HIGH

Mains 10M-1 - Distinguish maritime exploration, trading presence, fortified settlement and territorial empire. (150 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: These are cumulative but non-identical forms of power; confusing them makes conquest appear inevitable.
- Claim 1 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Vasco da Gama's Calicut voyage in 1498 opened direct Portuguese sea contact. It changed routes and bargaining but gave no jurisdiction over Calicut.
- Claim 2 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Surat 1613 was an EIC factory under Mughal permission - a warehouse-office-residence, not a manufacturing plant or province.
- Claim 3 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Fort St George after the 1639 Madras lease protected stock, specie and staff and supported a regional council, but its hinterland remained politically negotiated.
- Claim 4 -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Territorial empire required revenue, army, alliances and victory; Bengal's post-1757 fiscal turn belongs later and cannot explain the 1600 charter.
- Conclusion: The stages describe expanding capability, not an automatic legal or causal sequence.
- Why this earns marks: it defines all four terms, attaches a named example to each, explains what each proves and explicitly rejects teleology.

HIGH

Mains 10M-2 - Examine the Portuguese cartaz system and its limits. (150 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: The cartaz made Portuguese commerce an armed claim to regulate the sea, yet it never created complete Indian Ocean monopoly.
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Portuguese authorities required passes and could seize non-compliant ships, redirecting traffic and customs toward Diu, Goa or other nodes. Satish Chandra records merchant resentment at confiscation and compulsory customs at Diu. This treated shipping lanes as taxable political space. However, the Estado's manpower was thin, coastlines vast and Asian merchants capable of evasion or resistance.
- Claim -> evidence -> significance -> limit: Cannon-armed fleets and forts supported the system, while pressure on Mughal shipping extracted concessions. Yet Mughal capture of Portuguese Hugli in 1632, English victory at Swally in 1612 and Dutch expansion exposed its limits.
- Conclusion: Cartaz power was coercive and innovative but nodal, contested and dependent on diplomacy ashore.
- Why this earns marks: the answer defines the institution, names Diu-Hugli-Swally evidence, analyses mechanism and qualifies monopoly.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - European settlements were co-produced by Indian agency. Explain. (150 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: European companies supplied ships, capital and guns, but Indian rulers and port societies determined access, supply and political survival.
- Rulers: the Zamorin resisted Portuguese monopoly; Cochin allied with Portugal; Jahangir's government permitted Surat after English naval credibility; a local Nayak grant enabled Madras; Aurangzeb defeated the EIC in Child's War.
- Merchants and brokers: Virji Vohra, Armenian networks and dubashes supplied credit, information, procurement and customs mediation. Their interests could support, constrain or redirect a company.
- Producers and labour: Coromandel and Bengal weavers, shipbuilders, transporters and food suppliers made factories commercially viable. Fort walls never removed dependence on the surrounding town.
- Qualification: Agency operated within growing naval and corporate asymmetry; collaboration did not mean equal power.
- Conclusion: Before conquest, the settlement was a negotiated institution embedded in Indian sovereignty and economy.
- Why this earns marks: it integrates rulers, merchants and labour with five named examples and balances agency against asymmetry.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Explain why Dutch India remained commercially important but territorially secondary. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: Dutch strategy did not neglect India; it assigned Indian ports a commercial role inside an Indonesia-centred monopoly portfolio.
- Institution: the VOC charter of 1602 pooled capital and granted treaty, war and fortification powers. This made it a formidable company-state but did not dictate where it should conquer.
- Commercial engine: Pulicat and later Nagapattinam connected Coromandel textiles to intra-Asian trade; Surat linked Gujarat and West Asia; Chinsura and Bengal supplied silk, textiles and saltpetre. Indian cloth purchased Southeast Asian spices, so India was essential to VOC circulation.
- Strategic allocation: monopoly profits were concentrated in the Indonesian archipelago. Large Indian territorial commitments promised heavy military and political cost without the same monopoly logic.
- Indian politics: Nayaks, Mughal officials, merchants and weavers fixed land, customs and supply. Travancore's victory at Colachel in 1741 proved a regional state could defeat Dutch arms without ending Dutch commerce.
- Competition and qualification: Amboyna 1623 sharpened English-Dutch rivalry, while Bedara 1759 marked a later Bengal check. Yet Dutch factories survived; commercial contraction and political retreat were not identical.
- Conclusion: The Dutch outcome followed portfolio choice, local resistance and English competition - not simple commercial failure.
- Why this earns marks: it answers the apparent paradox, uses five bases/events, distinguishes strategic priority from capacity and avoids hindsight.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - Trace the English coastal chain to the early eighteenth century and assess its significance. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: The EIC built a diversified network by petition, lease and Crown transfer before it possessed territorial sovereignty.
- West: the 1600 charter enabled trade, but Swally 1612 and Mughal permission produced Surat 1613. Roe's 1615-19 embassy confirmed commercial privileges. Surat connected Mughal Gujarat to Red Sea and Persian Gulf circuits.
- Coromandel: Masulipatnam 1611 supplied textiles. A local Nayak lease in 1639 enabled Madras, and Fort St George protected stock and coordinated a growing council. Indian weavers and dubashes remained indispensable.
- Bombay: Portuguese possession passed to the English Crown in 1661 and to the Company in 1668. Its harbour and defensibility supported the 1687 presidency shift from Surat.
- Bengal: factories at Hugli and Kasimbazar preceded the cumulative three-village Calcutta settlement associated with 1690. Fort William and the 1698 zamindari rights strengthened the hub; Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman enlarged privileges.
- Significance: multiple bases diversified commodity access, information and naval reinforcement. Limitation: Child's War showed Mughal superiority; each base remained dependent on Indian rulers, merchants and labour.
- Conclusion: The chain created capacity for later intervention but not its inevitability.
- Why this earns marks: it traces four coasts chronologically, distinguishes legal routes and ends with both significance and a named reversal.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - Assess the cultural and material effects of the Portuguese presence in India. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: Portuguese influence outlasted their commercial primacy because maritime, missionary and urban institutions moved plants, print, religious practices and architectural forms; effects were creative and coercive.
- Religion: Francis Xavier reached Goa in 1542 as a founding Jesuit; his remains at Bom Jesus became a lasting devotional centre. Mission schools and orders institutionalised Catholic presence. Yet the Goa Inquisition from 1560 and coercive policy require a power-sensitive account.
- Print: the Goa press of 1556, conventionally India's first, linked movable type to missionary education and language work. Its significance was institutional diffusion, not immediate mass literacy.
- Biological transfer: the official 2025 UPSC key confirms papaya, pineapple and guava as Portuguese introductions in the sixteenth-seventeenth centuries. Chronologies for individual crops should not be over-specified.
- Architecture and society: ASI/UNESCO identify Old Goa's churches, including Bom Jesus and Se Cathedral, as major ensembles. European forms were adapted by local materials and artisans; mixed communities and maritime vocabulary also developed.
- Qualification: influence varied by region and did not erase existing cultures. Missions, trade, intermarriage, local patronage and resistance worked simultaneously.
- Conclusion: Portuguese decline was territorial-commercial, not cultural disappearance.
- Why this earns marks: the answer gives four dimensions, five dated/site anchors, a coercion counterpoint and chronology cautions.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Why did the English eventually gain relative advantage over the Portuguese, Dutch and French? Reject monocausal and teleological explanations. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: English advantage emerged from a contingent bundle - finance, navy, diversified bases, organisational continuity, Indian alliances and timing - rather than an innate national superiority or destiny fixed in 1600.
- Finance and state: shareholder capital, London credit, private trade and later the English fiscal-naval state sustained repeated voyages and war. Yet the EIC remained dependent on royal charter and naval protection; it was not purely private.
- Network: Surat, Madras, Bombay and Bengal diversified commodities and risk. Bombay's harbour, Fort St George's council and Bengal's textile-credit depth created mutually supporting nodes.
- Rival structures: the Portuguese Estado was overextended and resource-thin; VOC strategy rationally prioritised Indonesia; French India faced discontinuous naval-financial support and stronger home-state interference. These were strategic constraints, not stereotypes.
- Indian agency: Mughal permissions, Nayak leases, merchants, bankers, dubashes, sepoys and suppliers enabled English growth. Child's War and Indian victories such as Colachel prove that European triumph was never automatic.
- Timing: Bengal revenue after Plassey and Diwani later financed war, but cannot explain seventeenth-century footholds. It was a multiplier after political breakthrough.
- Conclusion: the EIC gained relative advantage because it learned, survived reverses and connected corporate and state resources to Indian political openings more consistently than rivals.
- Why this earns marks: it compares all four powers through common variables, separates early and late causes, centres Indian actors and directly rejects inevitability.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Compare the political structures and business models of the four major European powers in India. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: institutional design shaped strategic options, but outcomes arose only when design interacted with geography, home-state priorities and Indian politics.
- Portuguese: the Estado da India was a Crown network of viceroy, fleets, forts and royal factories. Cartaz coercion suited chokepoints, but monopoly rigidity, thin resources and religious conflict limited adaptation.
- Dutch: the 1602 VOC was a heavily capitalised joint-stock company with quasi-sovereign powers. Pulicat, Nagapattinam, Surat and Bengal supplied textiles and bulk goods to an Indonesia-first intra-Asian portfolio; India remained commercial rather than territorial priority.
- English: the 1600 EIC joined shareholder finance, private trade and a growing presidency system. Surat, Madras, Bombay and Calcutta produced a diversified network, though all early bases rested on permission, lease or transfer.
- French: the 1664 Compagnie des Indes combined monopoly trade with close royal sponsorship. Pondicherry and Chandernagore became capable hubs; Dupleix exploited claimant politics, but finance and naval support were less continuous.
- Comparison and limit: 'private versus state' is too crude - every company used public power and every company contained private interest. Indian rulers and merchants mediated all four.
- Conclusion: the English model proved relatively resilient, not universally superior; Dutch Indonesian success and Portuguese cultural durability require different measures of outcome.
- Why this earns marks: it compares through political form, finance, bases, strategy and limits, then qualifies the categories.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - 'A factory could become a fort, but a fort did not have to become an empire.' Critically discuss. (250 words)

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

CORE TEACHING / SOLVED CONTENT

- Thesis: the statement captures a conditional sequence. Commercial protection could generate fortification, but territorial sovereignty required additional fiscal, military and political transformations.
- Factory stage: Surat 1613 functioned under Mughal permission; Masulipatnam and Hugli linked company buyers to textile hinterlands. Factory meant depot and agents, not manufacture or province.
- Fortification: Fort St George after the 1639 Madras lease and Fort William in the 1690s protected stock, specie and staff and expanded internal jurisdiction. Yet host rulers could prohibit walls: Bengal nawabs repeatedly contested fortification.
- Regional coordination: Bombay's 1687 presidency shift and Madras councils improved information, shipping and garrison management. Administrative capacity created an option for intervention.
- Missing conditions: a company still needed durable finance, trained troops, Indian allies, political crisis, victory and revenue. Child's War showed that a fortified company could be defeated; Dutch factories remained commercial; Portuguese enclaves survived without expanding empire.
- Later bridge: Carnatic claimant politics and Bengal revenue converted military service into political and fiscal leverage. These were contingent conjunctures, not charter consequences.
- Conclusion: forts were infrastructure of possibility. Empire emerged only when corporate capacity met Indian political fragmentation and a fiscal breakthrough.
- Why this earns marks: it tests the quotation stage by stage, deploys successful and failed examples and identifies the missing causal conditions.

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI